According to Professor Dasgupta, "The ordinary difficulty, as to how entirely dissimilar wholes can come into contact with each other vanishes when we look at the point from Sānkhya-Yoga perspective."[14]

These interpreters perhaps take their stand on such statements as, "He is not homogeneous nor entirely heterogeneous"[15] and "Sattva purusayoh suddhi sāmye kaivalyam,"[16] where an attempt is made to bridge the gulf and make experience possible on a theory of the similarity of the Puruṣa and the Sattva. But the question is, does the attempt succeed? Buddhi may be pure and transparent by the predominance of Sattva in it, it may also be the highest evolute of Prakṛti, but that does not make it lose its character of being on the other side of the rigidly bifurcated reality. The subtlest and the finest evolute of Prakṛti is after all Prakṛti, and it cannot become identical with or share the nature of Puruṣa. If Puruṣa and Prakṛti meet in Sattva, as is supposed above, the dualism of Sānkhya-Yoga is virtually given up. The "physical and the mental may be the modifications of the same ultimate real," namely Pradhāna, yet they are not the modifications of the other ultimate reality, the Puruṣa, who is ever unmodified. Professor Dasgupta contradicts himself without realizing the contradiction when elsewhere he say that Buddhi, Ahankāra, and Manas, though psychical entities, do not belong to the Puruṣa; they are all stages in the evolution of the Prakṛti.

Does he mean that an evolution of Prakṛti when it becomes very pure and transparent becomes Puruṣa? The Sattva is either a constituent of the Guṇas (no matter how fine) and must be completely unlike the Puruṣa and incapable of any contact and reflection, or if it can take any reflection, it gives a lie to rigid dualism. If Sattva can become so fine and transparent as to be able to catch the reflection of Puruṣa, nothing prevents Sattva from becoming one with Puruṣa. One step more and Prakṛti and Puruṣa are ontologically one and the dualism is merged in monism. Such an easy solution of the difficulty confuses transparency with Cit. All Cit is transparent, but the converse is not true; the transparency of the crystal, the shining metals, and the water is not the same as intelligence. Partial resemblance cannot be stretched into perfect identity; otherwise Buddhi in the Kaivalya state would be identical with Puruṣa. The Sānkhya Kārikā definitely says that the dancer stops dancing after final separation is realized.[17]

So long as Buddhi is utterly different from Puruṣa, it does not improve matters to make it an intermediary or a hyper-physical entity. The problem of Sānkhya-Yoga is not only to make possible